



Renewable Energy Directive

The Renewable Energy Directive sets targets to increase the EU's renewable energy use. It supports cooperation between EU countries towards this goal.

Since the introduction of the Renewable Energy Directive (2009/28/EC), the share of renewable energy sources in EU energy consumption has increased from 12.5% in 2010 to 26.2% in 2025. Sweden had the highest share of renewables in its consumption (65.4%), ahead of Finland (53%) and Denmark (48.2%), as reported to [Eurostat](#).

Key facts

Global leader	26.2%	at least
EU leads	share of	42.5%
technology	renewables in	binding target
development in	EU energy	for the share of
renewables	consumption	renewables in
	2025	the energy mix
		by 2030

The EU is a global leader on renewables when it comes to technology development and deployment. In 2022, renewables accounted for 18.9% of the EU's total energy supply, compared to the global average of 13.9%. However, its competitiveness on global renewable energy markets could be further strengthened, as confirmed by a report on the [EU's global leadership in renewable energy](#), published in 2021.

Under the European Green Deal, renewable energy is a pillar of the clean energy transition. It comes at a low cost and is home-grown, which reduces Europe's dependency on external suppliers. This is why the EU's level of ambition on increasing the share of renewables in its energy mix and the measures needed to achieve this are regularly revisited.

The revised Directive



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Given the need to speed up the EU's clean energy transition, the Renewable Energy Directive EU/2018/2001 was revised in 2023.

The [amending Directive EU/2023/2413](#) entered into force on 20 November 2023 with an 18-month period to transpose most of the directive's provisions into national law, and a shorter deadline of July 2024 for some provisions related to [permitting for renewables](#).

It sets an overall [binding target](#) of at least 42.5% renewable energy in the EU's energy mix by 2030 but is aiming for 45%.

Renewable energy framework post-2030

To keep Europe on track towards meeting its energy and climate goals, the Commission is preparing a renewable energy framework for the next decade, scheduled for adoption by the end of 2026. It will seek to secure reliable, affordable, homegrown energy for European citizens and industry, and ensure that renewables contribute to the achievement of the 2040 EU climate target in a cost-efficient and sustainable way.

EU citizens and stakeholders are invited to provide feedback on the initiative through a [call for evidence and a public consultation](#) that are available 20 March – 12 June 2026.

Supporting implementation

To support the implementation of the Renewable Energy Directive, the Commission has published a series of guidances and recommendations for EU countries related to the revised directive, to help countries transpose its different elements into national law.

Articles 15a, 22a, 23 and 24: heating and cooling

[Guidance on the articles related to heating and cooling \(Articles 15a, 22a, 23 and 24\) in the Renewable Energy Directive](#)

Article 20a: energy system integration

[Guidance on the articles related to energy system integration \(Article 20a\) in the Renewable Energy Directive](#)

Following the guidance suggestion, an [ad hoc dialogue](#) was launched on 8 October 2024, during the Motor Vehicle Working Group (MVWG), followed by 2 ad hoc meetings on 25 October and 6 December of the same year. It focused on battery-related data sharing in real time and aimed to support EU countries in implementing the directive in line with this guidance and further specify the parameters and data that are not standardised yet. The dialogue involved the Commission, EU countries' representatives responsible for energy and transport, the industry and relevant stakeholders. Ad hoc dialogue documents.

The [Commission final notice based on the outcome of the dialogue](#) was published on 25 July 2025.

Articles 22a, 22b, and 25: RFNBOs

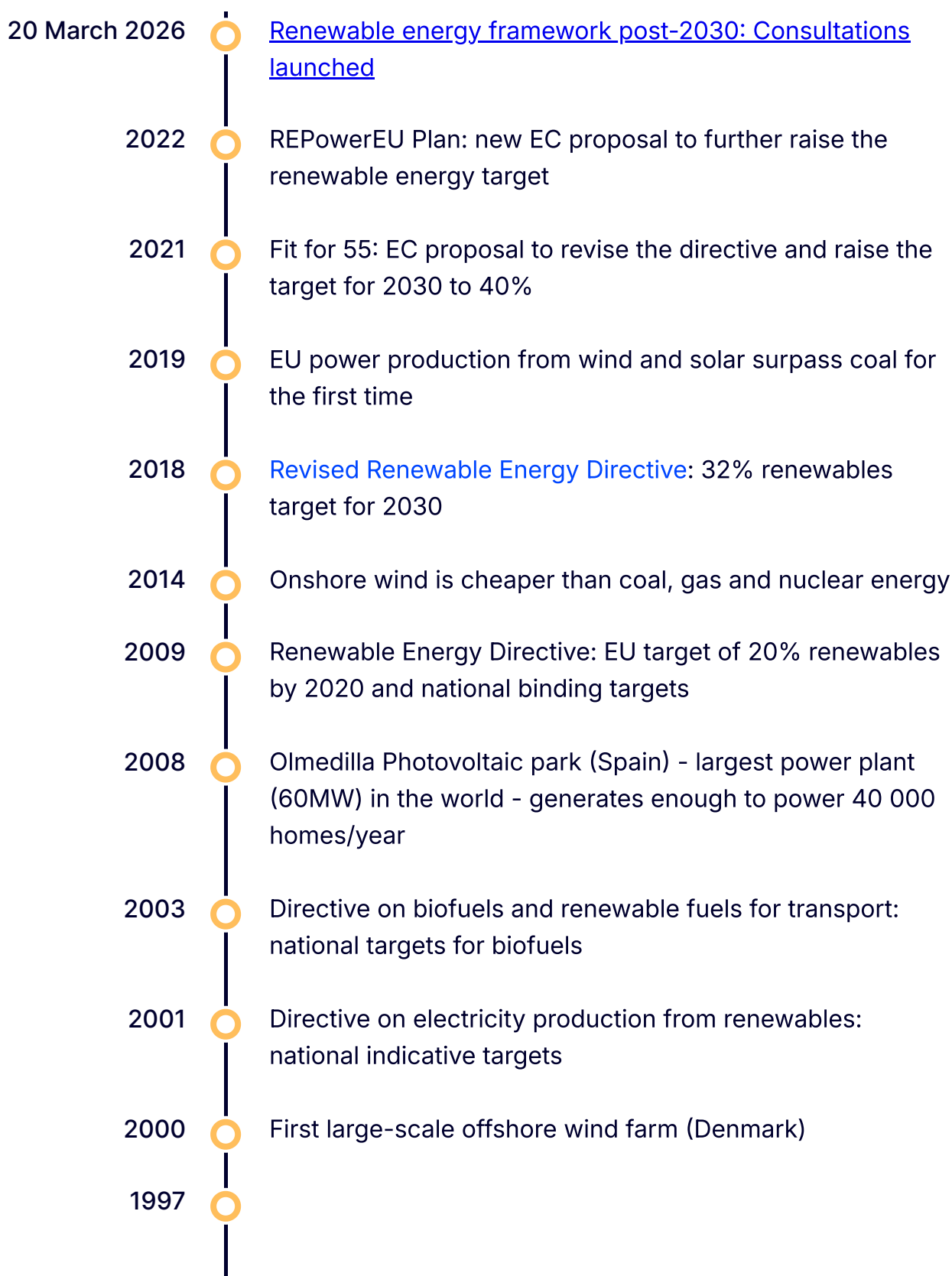
[Guidance on the articles related to RFNBOs \(Articles 22a, 22b, and 25\) in the Renewable Energy Directive](#)

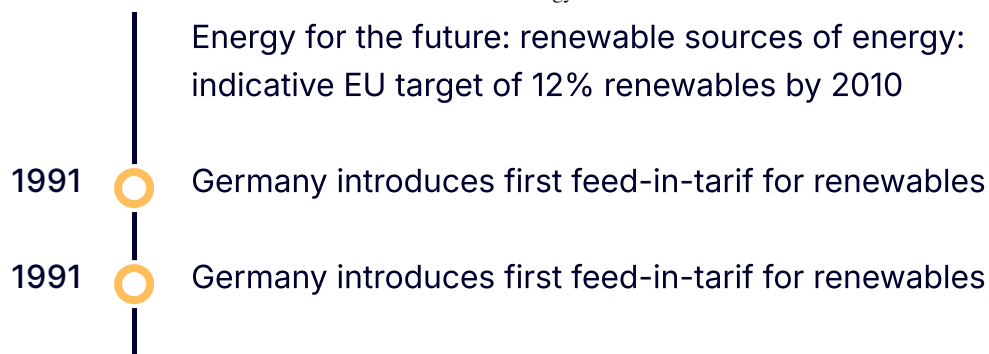
On 2 July 2025, the Commission [published](#) a recommendation and 3 guidance documents to lower energy costs and accelerate the clean energy transition. This includes a [guidance document on innovative technologies and forms of renewable energy deployment](#), in order to tap into the potential of innovative renewable energy technologies such as ocean energy, and of forms of renewable energy deployment, such as agrisolar. Under the guidance, EU countries should establish clear regulatory and financial frameworks to encourage their uptake and encourage continued research and innovation in the sector.

Additionally, the Commission supports the implementation of the Directive through the Accele-RES implementation plan as announced in the [European Wind Power Action Plan](#), meetings of the [Expert Group on permitting](#) and [CA-RES](#) [↗](#), a project of the HORIZON2020 Programme, which allows participating countries to exchange experiences and best practices, participate in a cross-learning process and develop

common approaches. An [implementation dialogue](#) on permitting for renewable energy projects and related infrastructure was held between Commissioner Jørgensen and stakeholders on 11 June 2025.

Timeline: EU renewable energy progress





In July 2021, the Commission [proposed a revision of the directive](#), raising the 2030 target for the share of renewable energy in the energy mix to 40% (up from 32%), as part of the 'Fit for 55' package, together with measures to increase renewables across the economy.

Less than a year later, following Russia's invasion of Ukraine and the need to accelerate the EU's independence from fossil fuels, the Commission [proposed to further increase](#) the target to 45% by 2030, together with measures to accelerate permitting for renewables.

On 30 March 2023, [a provisional agreement](#) was reached for a binding target of at least 42.5% share of renewable energy in the energy mix by 2030, but aiming for 45%.

The new legislation was [published on 31 October 2023](#) and entered into force 20 days later.

New measures for further uptake of renewables

Building on the 2009 and 2018 directives, the revised directive introduces stronger measures to ensure that all possibilities for the further development and uptake of renewables are fully utilised. This is key to achieving the [EU's objective of climate neutrality by 2050](#) and strengthening Europe's security of energy supply.

In addition to the new headline target to double the existing share of renewable energy sources, a strong policy framework will facilitate electrification in different sectors, with new increased sector-specific targets for renewables in heating and cooling, transport, industry, buildings and district heating/cooling, but also with a framework promoting electric vehicles and smart recharging.

To support renewables uptake in transport and heating and cooling, the revised directive introduces into EU law some of the concepts outlined in the [energy system integration and hydrogen strategies](#), published in 2020. These concepts aim at creating an energy-efficient, circular and renewable energy system that facilitates renewables-based electrification and promotes the use of renewable fuels, including hydrogen, in sectors

like transport or industry where electrification is not yet a feasible option. For these hard-to-electrify sectors, the directive sets new binding targets for [renewable fuels of non-biological origin](#).

As an important bottleneck to the deployment of renewables on the ground, permitting procedures will also be easier and faster both for renewable energy projects, including through shorter approval periods and the creation of '[Renewables acceleration areas](#)', and for the necessary infrastructure projects.

As we phase out fossil fuels, [bioenergy](#) will also have a role to play. Therefore, the sustainability criteria are reinforced by the revised directive.

Directive 2018/2001/EU

The [Renewable Energy Directive](#) (2018/2001/EU) entered into force in December 2018, as part of the [Clean energy for all Europeans package](#).

It established a new binding renewable energy target for the EU for 2030 of at least 32% renewable energy in the energy mix, with a clause for a possible upwards revision by 2023. This target was a continuation of the 20% target for 2020.

It also included new provisions to allow citizens to play an active role in the development of renewables by enabling [renewable energy communities](#) and self-consumption of renewable energy and established better criteria to ensure bioenergy's sustainability.

Related links

Legislation

- [Consolidated version: Revised Renewable Energy Directive](#) (2023)
- [Revised Renewable Energy Directive \(EU/2023/2413\)](#)
- [Proposal for an amendment to the Renewable Energy Directive \(COM/2022/222\)](#) (May 2022)
- [Proposal for an amendment to the Renewable Energy Directive to implement the ambition of the new 2030 climate target \(COM/2021/ 557\)](#) (July 2021)
- [Revised Renewable Energy Directive \(2018/2001/EU\)](#)
- [Clean energy for all Europeans package](#)
- [Renewable Energy Directive \(2009/28/EC\)](#)

- [News: EU agrees stronger legislation to accelerate the rollout of renewable energy \(30 March 2023\)](#)
- [Study: EU's global leadership in renewables \(September 2022\)](#)
- [REPowerEU: affordable, secure and sustainable energy for Europe](#)
- [Study: Technical support for RES policy development and implementation \(September 2021\)](#)
- [European Climate Law](#)
- [Delivering on the Green Deal](#)
- [Energy communities](#)